Faculty of Information Technology
FIT3161 Computer Science Project Part 1
FIT3163 Data Science Project Part 1

Marking rubric for final project report

Introduction (10)	The Introduction briefly: ● Introduces the project and team. ● Sets the background, context, problem or opportunity for the project. ● Outlines the project outcome as achieved. ● Introduces the report, outlines its structure and provides a clear overview of each section.
HD 80 - 100	● Professionally written, including all of the above. ● Provides a simple, clear and accurate indication of what to expect in the report.
D 70 - <80	● Well written, including most of the above. ● Provides a somewhat simple, mostly clear and/or mostly true indication of what to expect in the report.
C 60 - <70	● Readable, including some of the above. ● Provides a somewhat simple, not always clear and/or ambiguous indication of what to expect in the report.
P 50 - <60	● Contains errors or is poorly worded, includes perhaps a half of what is required, and provides a basic coverage of what to expect in the report.
N <50	● Fails to meet requirements with regard to writing quality and/or content. Some marks will be allocated for the contents.

Project background summary (10)	● The background section cites relevant literature taken from the Project Proposal, and highlights what has changed or been updated since the time of the previous submission. ● It discusses and synthesises the key relevant points summarised in a couple of paragraphs that address realised components of the project (e.g. project topic addressed, use-cases handled, user interface design as required by the specified target users, data analysis techniques employed, user testing implemented etc.). ● It may include references to grey literature, academic literature, software, hardware (if relevant). ● Covers evidence of a gap/opportunity that the project now fills/meets, discusses existing “competing” tools addressing the main project goals and how the project differs from them. ● Any references are cited and appear in a Bibliography in APA or IEEE format.
HD 80 - 100 Demonstrates exceptional understanding and synthesis of relevant	● Presents well-integrated summary discussion of academic and grey literature, including relevant software/hardware references clearly updated since the proposal. ● Synthesises and critically analyses how the project as delivered addresses identified gaps or opportunities, clearly differentiating it from existing competing

literature and project evolution, providing a comprehensive and insightful context for the project.	tools. ● Provides accurate and consistent citations and bibliography in correct APA or IEEE format throughout.
D 70 - <80 Demonstrates strong understanding and integration of relevant literature and project context with clear evidence of development since the proposal.	● Provides a summary review of relevant sources with minor omissions, clearly identifying key updates or changes since the proposal. ● Offers clear discussion of the project's relevance and distinctiveness compared to existing tools, supported by appropriate examples. ● Shows mostly consistent and accurate referencing using APA or IEEE format.
C 60 - <70 Demonstrates sound understanding of project background and literature, though discussion and synthesis may lack depth or clarity in places.	● Includes updates relating to some literature and sources, though possibly in a limited, outdated way, or in a way that is insufficiently connected to the project as delivered. ● Describes project development and differentiating features but provides limited critical comparison or analysis. ● Citations are generally correct, with minor inconsistencies or formatting issues.
P 50 - <60 Demonstrates basic understanding of the project's background and context, but lacks depth, synthesis, or clear connection to the project's evolution.	● References insufficient updates to literature or competing products, may be descriptive rather than analytical, with minimal updates or links to the project's final delivery state. ● Provides limited discussion of gaps, competing tools, or the project's distinct contribution. ● Referencing is attempted but contains frequent errors, omissions or inconsistencies.
N <50 Demonstrates little or no understanding of the project's background or context; lacks evidence of research, synthesis, or correct referencing.	● Provides minimal or irrelevant discussion of literature, with few or no credible sources cited and very few links to the project as finally delivered. ● Fails to address project evolution, competing tools, or contextual gaps meaningfully. ● Referencing may be absent or incorrect, showing no adherence to APA or IEEE conventions.

Outcomes (30)	The Outcomes section reports on all of the results achieved by the project and the user requirements satisfied. It explains what product or service has been delivered, and justifies the key decisions made in the project's realisation.

	A thorough and honest discussion of the project's level of success, including the work's limitations and possible improvements or future work are presented. The Requirements Traceability Matrix is included to show the status of all requirements at the conclusion of the project.
HD 80 - 100 Demonstrates exceptional clarity, depth, and honesty in reporting project results, with comprehensive evaluation of outcomes, requirements, and future directions.	● Provides a complete and detailed account of all results achieved, clearly linked to user requirements and supported by an accurate Requirements Traceability Matrix. ● Explains and justifies key decisions in project realisation with strong reasoning and evidence. ● Delivers a thorough and reflective evaluation of success, acknowledging limitations and offering insightful, feasible recommendations for improvement or future work.
D 70 - <80 Demonstrates strong understanding and clear reporting of project outcomes, with well-reasoned discussion and critical reflection.	● Presents a comprehensive summary of project results and user requirements met, with a mostly complete Requirements Traceability Matrix. ● Provides clear explanations and justification for key project decisions, supported by appropriate evidence. ● Includes a thoughtful discussion of project success, limitations, and future improvements, though some aspects may lack depth.
C 60 - <70 Demonstrates competent reporting of project results with some reflection and justification, though lacking in completeness or analytical depth.	● Summarises main outcomes and requirements satisfied, though some results or requirements are missing or inadequately addressed. ● Offers basic justification for major decisions, though reasoning may be underdeveloped or uneven. ● Provides some reflection on project success and limitations, but discussion may be brief or superficial; Traceability Matrix may be incomplete or inconsistently detailed.
P 50 - <60 Demonstrates a basic understanding of project outcomes with limited analysis or reflection on decisions, success, or future work.	● Provides a simplified or partial account of results and user requirements, with gaps or unclear connections to the Traceability Matrix. ● Offers minimal or unclear justification for project decisions. ● Includes a brief and general discussion of success and limitations, lacking critical analysis or forward-looking insight.
N <50 Demonstrates poor or absent reporting of project results, with little evidence of reflection,	● Fails to report meaningful outcomes or to relate results to user requirements; Traceability Matrix missing or incorrect. ● Provides no clear rationale or justification for decisions made during project development. ● Omits or misrepresents discussion of success, limitations, or potential improvements.

justification, or fulfilment of requirements.	

Methodology (15) & Sample code (5)	The Methodology section should provide sufficient detail to enable another developer or team to follow the same steps and processes as your team to produce the same results. It should fully describe: ● Software, utilities, tools you used to develop your project. ● Data collection, management and processing steps that you carried out. ● Software development steps that you undertook. The Sample code should include 50 - 100 lines with full inline documentation representative of the rest of the code. It should detail at least one function and its call, and demonstrate the satisfaction of at least 1 software requirement from the RTM.
HD 80 - 100 Demonstrates exceptional understanding and attention to detail; methodology is comprehensive, precise, and fully replicable.	● Provides a complete and unambiguous description of all required software, tools, and utilities, including libraries, programming languages, and data management requirements. ● Outlines a clear, detailed, and logical step-by-step methodology that covers all stages of development and processing. ● Offers thorough justification for all decisions, enabling another developer to replicate results exactly. ● Code is clearly set out and is representative of the remainder of the software. It is fully and clearly documented, includes a function and its call, and demonstrates a requirement from the RTM.
D 70 - <80 Demonstrates strong understanding and organisation; methodology is clear, detailed, and largely replicable with minor clarifications needed.	● Provides a clear and mostly complete description of software, tools, and utilities, with only minor omissions or ambiguities. ● Presents a logical and detailed workflow, describing most development and data steps clearly. ● Gives sound justification for most decisions, allowing replication with minimal additional clarification. ● Code may be mostly clearly set out and is representative of the remainder of the software. It is clearly documented with only minor ambiguity of missing details, includes a function and its call, and demonstrates a requirement from the RTM.
C 60 - <70 Demonstrates competent understanding; methodology is adequate but lacks depth, precision, or full justification.	● Provides a reasonable description of most required software and tools, though some important details are missing. ● Outlines key development and data management steps, but lacks clarity or depth in certain areas. ● Gives partial justification of decisions; replication would require assumptions or clarifications. ● Code is somewhat mostly clearly set out and is representative of the remainder of the software. It is documented but there may be a couple of minor ambiguities of missing details, includes a function and its call, and demonstrates a requirement from the RTM.

P 50 - <60 Demonstrates basic understanding; methodology is incomplete or loosely structured, with limited clarity or justification.	• Provides a basic or incomplete list of software and tools, omitting several key components or steps. • Shows limited structure or detail in describing development and data processes. • Offers minimal or unclear justification for decisions; replication would be difficult without further information. • Code is present but not clearly set out and is representative of the remainder of the software. It is documented but there may be several ambiguities or missing details, includes a function and its call, and demonstrates a requirement from the RTM.
N <50 Demonstrates poor or insufficient understanding; methodology is unclear, incomplete, or non-replicable.	• Fails to provide clear or accurate details about required software, tools, or processes. • Displays unclear, inconsistent, or illogical sequencing of development and data steps. • Shows little to no justification or understanding of methodology; replication is not possible. • Some marks may be awarded for content. • Code is present but may be poorly set out or not representative of the remainder of the software. It is documented poorly and is missing important details. It may be missing a function and its call, or it may not demonstrate a requirement from the RTM.

Software and Project Critique (15)	This section provides the reader with a critique of both what has been achieved, and the way in which it was achieved. The Outcomes section above noted the limitations of the project, you do not need to repeat this material, instead, here you should discuss the reasons for the limitations, were they all intentional? If not, what events led to the omission of some aspects of the project you had hoped to achieve? How successful was your project management? Did your project run to plan? Did you adhere to the schedule? Was your team communication effective? Was the workload well distributed? Did you meet all of your client's expectations? How, why, or why not? How do you manage this relationship with the client or supervisor?
HD 80-100 Demonstrates exceptional critical insight into both the project's outcomes and processes, offering a balanced, reflective, and evidence-based evaluation of performance.	• Provides a thorough, honest, and analytical discussion of both achievements and shortcomings, clearly identifying causes of limitations and linking them to project decisions or external factors. • Evaluates project management practices comprehensively, including scheduling, communication, workload distribution, and client/supervisor relationships. • Offers deep reflection and justified insights on lessons learned, with clear, evidence-based understanding of how future practice could be improved.
D 70 - <80 Demonstrates strong reflective and analytical understanding of	• Presents a well-structured critique addressing both what was achieved and the factors behind limitations, with mostly strong reasoning and honesty. • Assesses project management and teamwork effectively, noting successes and areas for improvement in communication, planning, and workload balance. • Provides thoughtful reflection on lessons learned, though some analysis may lack

project processes and outcomes, with clear reasoning and insight.	depth or nuance.
C 60 - <70 Demonstrates a competent critique with clear reflection on project outcomes and management, though with limited depth or specificity.	● Provides a reasonable discussion of project achievements and limitations, identifying some causes but with limited critical insight. ● Comments on management and communication aspects in general terms, but may overlook key details or examples. ● Offers basic reflection on lessons learned, though connections between analysis and improvement are weak or undeveloped.
P 50 - <60 Demonstrates basic awareness of project successes and challenges, but lacks analytical depth, clarity, or reflection.	● Provides a surface-level critique, mentioning achievements and limitations with little or no discussion of underlying causes. ● Briefly mentions management or teamwork factors, but analysis is vague or unsupported by evidence. ● Offers minimal or general reflection, showing limited understanding of lessons learned or future improvements.
N <50 Demonstrates little or no critical reflection or understanding of project processes or outcomes.	● Fails to provide meaningful critique of project achievements, limitations, or causes of issues. ● Omits or misrepresents discussion of project management, teamwork, or communication effectiveness. ● Shows no genuine reflection or learning, offering unsupported or irrelevant commentary.

Conclusion (5)	The conclusion completes the report and summarises its key points.
HD 80 - 100	Clearly and succinctly written, recaps all major points. Clearly relates to the project, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
D 70 - <80	Clearly and succinctly written, recaps the points presented earlier. Relates well to the project, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
C 60 - <70	Well written, recapping most of the points presented earlier. Relates to most of the project ideas, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
P 50 - <60	This shows an attempt to recap most of the points presented earlier. Relates somewhat to the project, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
N <50	An inadequate attempt that misses many key points and/or is poorly written. Some marks may be awarded for content.

Style & Presentation (5) References (5)	
HD 80 - 100 Exceptionally professional and polished presentation that meets or exceeds all academic and formatting standards.	• Consistently excellent formatting including considered use of fonts, indentation, line and paragraph spacing, and white space. • Section headings and subheadings are consistently numbered, correctly aligned with the Table of Contents, and used in cross referencing appropriately between document sections. • Excellent English expression, clearly written, easy to follow, correct spelling and grammar. • Diagrams are clear, labelled, numbered and referred to correctly in the main text. • The front cover sheet includes all required information. • References are provided in the correct format and are properly cited within the document.
D 70 - <80 Strong, well-presented report with minor inconsistencies that do not detract from readability or professionalism.	• Very good formatting and visual presentation; minor inconsistencies in spacing, font size, or alignment. • Headings and numbering are mostly correct, well applied and align with the Table of Contents; cross-references generally used appropriately. • Very good English expression; clear and mostly fluent with only occasional minor grammar or spelling errors. • Diagrams are clear and labelled but may have minor visual issues. • Front cover includes all required information with only minor formatting inconsistencies. • References are correctly formatted with minor citation or formatting errors.
C 60 - <70 Competently presented report showing sound effort but some inconsistency or lack of refinement.	• Adequate formatting, though inconsistencies in spacing, font use, or layout are evident. • Headings and numbering are present but occasionally inconsistent with the Table of Contents; cross-referencing used irregularly. • Writing is generally clear, though contains several minor grammar or spelling errors and occasional awkward phrasing. • Diagrams are included and labelled but may be inconsistently formatted or not referred to clearly in text. They may be slightly unclear. • Front cover includes most required information, but layout or detail may be inconsistent. • References are mostly accurate but contain several formatting or citation inconsistencies.
P 50 - <60 Adequate presentation with frequent inconsistencies or basic errors that limit clarity or professionalism.	• Formatting is inconsistent or poorly applied; spacing, font use, or alignment issues are common. • Headings and numbering partially implemented or inaccurate; Table of Contents misaligned or incomplete; cross-referencing rarely used. • Writing is understandable but contains frequent grammar and spelling errors; structure may hinder readability. • Diagrams are present but poorly labelled, unclear, or not referenced correctly. • Front cover is missing some required information or incorrectly formatted. • References are present but poorly formatted, incomplete, or inconsistently cited.
N <50	• Formatting is disorganized or absent; little evidence of consistent design or layout

Poorly presented report that lacks clarity, consistency, or adherence to academic standards.	consideration. ● Headings and numbering missing or incorrect; Table of Contents absent or inaccurate; no cross-referencing. ● Writing is unclear, frequently incorrect, or difficult to follow due to numerous language and grammar errors. ● Diagrams missing, unreadable, unclear or unlabelled; not referenced in text. ● Front cover missing or lacking most required details. ● References largely missing, incorrect, or not cited in the text.